

MScAC Initiative Budget Proposal

Event: Drop-in Wellness Café

Date: Thursday, January 22, 2026, 3:00 PM to 8:00 PM

Venue: MScAC Office (large common room)

Estimated Attendance: 20–25 (20 current students, plus additional senior students and alumni dropping in during the evening)

Purpose

This event is designed to support MScAC students during the peak of internship recruiting season, a period that is often marked by heightened stress, isolation, and burnout. Rather than a structured workshop, the Drop-in Wellness Café provides a low-pressure, welcoming environment where students can decompress, work quietly, or connect socially. By extending the event into the evening and inviting seniors and alumni after the end of their workday, the café also creates organic opportunities for mentorship, informal advice, and reassurance from those who have recently navigated similar recruiting cycles.

Event Components

Wellness Café (3:00 PM – 6:00 PM)

The afternoon portion will emphasize calm, flexible use of space. The room will be arranged with tables and soft seating to allow students to sit alone or in small groups at low volume.

- **Beverages:** Hot tea (assorted bags sourced from the MScAC pantry), iced tea, isotonic drinks, and bottled water.
- **Snacks:** Individually portioned, easy-to-eat items such as MadeGood granola bites, fruit (bananas, apples, clementines), and light packaged snacks.
- **Quiet Space:** A small beanbag and book/reading corner to encourage rest and decompression alongside light independent work.

Dinner & Evening Drop-in (6:00 PM – 8:00 PM)

The evening segment will be more social while maintaining a relaxed atmosphere.

- **Dinner:** A mix of finger foods to allow for easy grazing and conversation, including pizza and small-scale Asian catering (e.g., dumplings, noodles, or rice-based trays).
- **Networking:** Seniors and alumni are invited to drop in, eat, and casually connect with current students. No formal programming is planned, keeping interactions natural and student-driven.
- **Flow:** Food will be served buffet-style, allowing attendees to come and go without disruption.

RSVP Plan

- Interest has already been gauged via a Discord poll among current students, with 19 responses indicating availability for this date and time.
- A lightweight RSVP form will be circulated to current students to confirm attendance and dietary restrictions.
- Seniors and alumni in Toronto will be notified via the 2024 Discord channel and MScAC mailing lists earlier in the week of the event; catering quantities will be finalized based on confirmed current-student RSVPs with a buffer for alumni drop-ins.
- Post-Event: Students will be encouraged to share photos and tag MScAC on social media.

Budget & Vendor Estimates

*see quotes document

Item	Vendor / Source	Estimated Cost
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Pizza (6–8 large pizzas)	Local pizza vendor Fresca*	\$225
Light Asian catering (small trays)	Local caterer Mr Yes (or other if I can source cheaper)*	\$350
Healthy snacks (granola bites, fruit, packaged snacks)	Grocery / Costco	\$250
Cold drinks (iced tea, isotonic drinks, water)	Dollarama / Grocery	\$175
Misc. supplies (cups, napkins, plates)	Dollarama	\$75
Wellness packets / wellness items small pouf/ottoman, stress-relief handhelds, warm LED lamps, massage roller, neutral table elements)	IKEA	\$175
Estimated Total		\$1,250

Other Next Steps

- Confirm room availability (9014/9016) and finalize layout plan for quiet, low-volume use.
- Finalize catering orders based on RSVP counts and dietary needs.
- Promote the event across MScAC Discord and mailing lists.
- Collect receipts, attendance list, and event documentation for reimbursement submission.

Contingency

- If the event cannot be held on 15 January for reasons such as room unavailability, the backup date is **22 January run in the same way**. Discord polls have confirmed interest (18 students indicated the date as preferred).

Total Budget Requested: \$1,250